

However, do not generally use a comma if the dependent-word group comes at the end of a sentence.

e.g. My daughter refused to stop smoking unless I quit also.

Tommy made an appointment which he did not intend to keep.

- 2 Sometimes the dependent words *who*, *that*, *which*, or *where* appear not at a very start, but near the start, of a word group. A fragment often results:

The town council decided to put more lights on South Street. A place where several people have been mugged.

"A place where several people have been mugged" is not in itself a complete thought. We want to know in the same statement *where the place was* that several people were mugged. The fragment can be corrected by attaching it to the sentence that comes before it:

e.g. The town council decided to put more lights on South Street, a place where several people have been mugged.

Activity 1

Turn each of the following dependent-word groups into a sentence by adding a complete thought. Put a comma after the dependent-word group if a dependent word starts the sentence.

Examples Although I arrived in class late

Although I arrived in class late, I still did well on the test.

e.g. The little boy who plays with our daughter

The little boy who plays with our daughter just came down with German measles.

1. Because the weather is bad, I prefer to stay inside.

2. If I lend you twenty dollars, you'll surely waste them.

3. The car that we bought has some amazing features. It is a chevy car.

4. Since I was tired, I took a nap.

5. Before the instructor entered the room, the class was an actual visual representation of a zoo.

Activity 2 Which feature of the formal writing is not incorporated in the given sentence?
Underline the dependent-word fragment or fragments in each item. Then correct each fragment by attaching it to the sentence that comes before or the sentence that comes after it—whichever sounds more natural. Put a comma after the dependent-word group if it starts the sentence.

1. When my neighbor and I both use our cordless telephones, ^{we} we hear one another's conversations. One of us needs to get a different phone.

1) Hence,
2) Hence,
When my neighbor... telephones, we hear... conversations. Hence, one of... phone.

2. Bill always turns on the radio in the morning to hear the news. He wants to be sure that World War III has not started. Before he gets on with his day.

1) Bill always... news before he gets... day. He... not started.

2) Bill... news. He wants to... started before he... day.

3) Before... day, he always turns... news.

3. Although Mr. Simon is over eighty years old, He walks briskly to work every day. He seems like a much younger man. Since he is so active and involved in life.

1) Although... old, he walks... day. He seems... man since he is... life.

2) Although... old, he walks... day. Since he... life, he seems... man.

(1 d1)

- 4 My dog ran in joyous circles on the wide beach. Until she found a dead fish.
Before I had a chance to drag her away. She began sniffing and nudging the
smelly remains.

1) My dog ... beach until she ... fish. Before I ... away, she
began ... remains.

a chance ... away. 2) My dog ... beach until she ... fish. She began ... remains before I had

5. When the air conditioner broke down, The temperature was over ninety
degrees. I then found an old fan, which turned out to be broken also.

1) When the ... down, the temp ... degrees. I then ... fan which

turned out ... also.

2) The temperature ... degrees when the ... down. I then ... fan which turned
out to ... also.

-ing and to Fragments

(When an -ing word appears at or near the start of a word group, a fragment may result. Such fragments often lack a subject and part of the verb.) Underline the word groups in the examples below that contain -ing words. Each is a fragment.